Design Document Outline

Group Members:

Game Title:

1 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

- Most Important Page of Design Doc. In many cases the only page that is read. Objective is to get a meeting with a producer or publisher
- Usually 20-25 lines in length. Include 1 or 2 sentence descriptions of high concept, target audience, market appeal, game play, implementation details, schedule
- Needs to communicate the game concept quickly, clearly and with enthusiasm

2 GAME DESIGN - CREATIVE

2.1 High Concept

What is the basic concept of your game?

2.2 Design Goals

2.2.1 Main Design Features

What is it like to play the game, including:

2.2.1.1 Player goals and objectives.

Main goal
Secondary goals
Type of challenge(s)
Type of conflict(s)
Winning condition – how does the player win the game?

2.2.1.2 Main rules and procedures

Operational rules – how do you play the game?
Main game mechanic – Describe the main way the user interacts with the system
On a second by second basis
On a minute by minute basis
What makes this fun or interesting?

2.2.1.3 Player Resources

Types of resources?

How does the player use resources to achieve goals?

2.2.1.4 Boundaries and Constraints

Describe the game environment and any limitations it imposes on the game play

2.2.2 Appeal

What is the game genre?
Who is the target audience?
What is their age?
Why is the game fun to play?
Assume the reader is a publisher. You must "sell" them on why what you are developing is interesting or appeals to your target audience.

2.2.3 Look and Feel

Style of artwork. Color schemes. What other games is it similar to?

2.3 Worlds, Characters and Story

2.3.1 Back Story

If appropriate, how you will reveal this to the user

2.3.2 Spaces/Worlds

<u>Make sure you include sketches of the worlds along with brief descriptions</u>

2.3.3 Characters

<u>Make sure you include sketches of all the characters</u> along with brief descriptions of their personalities and capabilities

2.3.4 Levels of Difficulty

How will you vary the level of difficulty?

2.4 Interaction Models

2.4.1 User Interface - Navigation and Movement

What does the game user interface look like and how does it work? Provide a mockup sketch or image.

2.4.2 Game Play Sequence and Levels

Show in the form of a flowchart and provide descriptions of transitions

2.4.3 User/Environment – Obstacles and Props

How does the user interact with the environment? How will you handle collision detection? Physics? Object manipulation, etc. Be specific.

2.4.4 User/Character

How does the user interact with his character and other characters? Be specific.

2.4.5 Character/Character

How do characters interact? How will you handle collision detection, AI, physics, etc. Be specific.

2.4.6 Puzzle Design

If appropriate, describe any puzzles you plan to use in your game design. Provide sketches of typical puzzle game play sequences in the Storyboard section 3.2

2.4.7 Motion Tracking

If appropriate, describe the motion tracking features of your game

2.4.8 Multi-Player

If appropriate, describe the multi-player mode

2.4.9 Mobile

If appropriate, describe the mobile features of your game

2.4.10 Networked Play

If appropriate, describe networked play

2.5 Performance and Scoring

2.5.1 State Variables

What are all the character, environment and gameplay variables necessary to save/restore or pause/resume the game or virtual world experience?

2.5.2 Feedback

What are the positive and negative feedback mechanisms you plan to employ and how do they affect the game play (i.e. help or hurt player performance)?

2.5.3 Performance and Progress Metrics

How will you monitor player progress regarding achieving the game's goals and objectives? How do you win? How do you lose?

3 GAME DESIGN - IMPLEMENTATION DETAILS

3.1 Design Assumptions

3.1.1 Hardware

Minimum hardware configuration (i.e. processor speed, memory requirement, graphics card, etc.) necessary to run game

3.1.2 Software

Version of Game Engine, Windows, DirectX, etc. required to run game

3.1.3 Algorithms and Techniques

What specific algorithms, plug-ins, animation techniques, etc. will you be using to implement your game? Be specific.

3.2 Storyboards

Show storyboard sketches of your game environment, puzzles and gameplay sequences here. This should convey the look and feel of the game as well as illustrate the basic game play.

3.3 Design Logic

3.3.1 Finite State Machines – Events/States/Effects

Provide as much detail as possible as you can of your game logic in the form of a FSM graph. You can sketch this by hand or use Visio, whichever is easier

3.3.2 User Solution/Actions

Describe how the player wins the game. Include descriptions of puzzles shown in Section 3.2 that must be solved. Provide as much detail as possible

3.4 Software Versions

3.4.1 Alpha Version Features (vertical slice through total experience)

The alpha version(s) represents the first time the game is "playable". List the set of features you will be demoing in the alpha version of your game.

3.4.2 Beta Version Features

List the complete set of features to be included in the beta version

3.4.3 Descriptions of any tutorial levels and/or self-running Demos

4 WORK PLAN

4.1 Tasks

List and number **ALL** the tasks and subtasks which are necessary to develop your game application.

Provide separate descriptions of each task and subtask, which members of the group are assigned to it, and the expected task duration (in days). Be as detailed as you can.

Use the following format for each of your Work Plan tasks.

Task n – *Task Name*	
	Duration: xx Days

Describe what you plan to do in this task. Should be of sufficient detail that the reader can understand exactly what you will be doing (at least 3 sentences).

- ***Subtask n.1.*** *Use a descriptive task name*
  In two or three sentences describe what you plan to do in this subtask.
- ***Subtask n.2.*** *Use a descriptive task name*
  In two or three sentences describe what you plan to do in this subtask.
- ***Subtask n.3.*** *Use a descriptive task name*
  In two or three sentences describe what you plan to do in this subtask.

4.2 Milestones

4.2.1 Minor

On a week by week basis describe the functionality you plan to achieve (and will be able to demonstrate)

4.2.2 Major

Describe the major milestones of the project.

Alpha Version

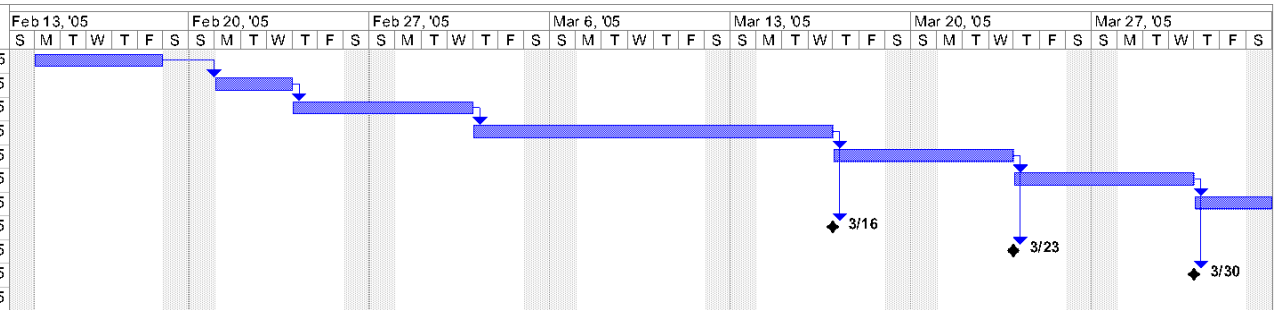
Describe the main functionality you plan to achieve and demonstrate in the version.

Beta Versions

Describe the main functionality you plan to achieve and demonstrate in the beta version(s).

4.3 Development Schedule

Organize your work plan tasks in the form of a Gantt chart (http://www.gantt.com/). List all the major tasks and subtasks (including durations) and the dates of each minor (weekly) milestone and major milestone (e.g. alpha, beta, final). Please use Microsoft Project for the creation of the Development Schedule.

Example Gantt Chart

ID	Task Name	Duration	Start	Finish
1	Task1	5 days	Mon 2/14/05	Fri 2/18/05
2	Task2	3 days	Mon 2/21/05	Wed 2/23/05
3	Task3	5 days	Thu 2/24/05	Wed 3/2/05
4	Task4	10 days	Thu 3/3/05	Wed 3/16/05
5	Task5	5 days	Thu 3/17/05	Wed 3/23/05
6	Task6	5 days	Thu 3/24/05	Wed 3/30/05
7	Task7	5 days	Thu 3/31/05	Wed 4/6/05
8	Alpha Version	0 days	Wed 3/16/05	Wed 3/16/05
9	Beta1 Version	0 days	Wed 3/23/05	Wed 3/23/05
10	Beta2 Version	0 days	Wed 3/30/05	Wed 3/30/05
11	Final	0 days	Wed 4/6/05	Wed 4/6/05